



IRANIANS gather for slain Supreme Leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei’s funeral in Mashhad on Thursday.

RENEWED FIGHTING IMPERILS U.S.-IRAN CEASEFIRE

Tehran’s discussions with others in region may suggest effort to reduce hostilities.

By JON GAMBRELL

DUBAI — The United States launched new airstrikes against Iran early Thursday, and Tehran responded by targeting U.S.-allied countries in an exchange of fire that threatened an interim deal intended to help end the war in the Middle East.

Back-and-forth attacks, including a day earlier, have repeatedly threatened the ceasefire. But Thursday’s appeared bigger all around, with sirens sounding at least three times in Bahrain, where the U.S. Navy’s 5th Fleet is based, and missiles targeting Kuwait and Qatar.

Sirens sounded Thursday afternoon in Jordan as well, where the U.S. has stationed troops and aircraft.

An Iranian official accused the U.S. of launching an airstrike later Thursday targeting the area around Iran’s sole nuclear power plant, and other explosions were reported elsewhere in the country during the afternoon.

The strikes came hours after President Trump said recent Iranian attacks on ships in the Strait of Hormuz signaled the end of a fragile ceasefire and threatened to escalate the conflict if they didn’t stop. That raised concerns that the region could tip back into a war that would engulf several countries and could halt energy shipments through the strait that are crucial for the global economy.

In Iran, the two days of American airstrikes have killed at least 14 people and wounded 78 others, Iran’s Health Ministry said Thursday. Most were reportedly members of the armed forces.

In Kuwait, the military said falling debris wounded [See **Fighting**, A4]

In a cellular city, they still want their landlines

By Jenny Jarvie

Living high up in the Hollywood Hills, Peter and Nanci Ellis think of their landline as a lifeline.

Most days, cellphone service in their Los Feliz Oaks home near Griffith Park is so spotty that they rely on their traditional phone for medical consultations, job interviews or any call with long wait times.

But the landline is also essential in their neighborhood — which has few roads in and out and is at high risk of fires and earthquake landslides — because it connects to their alarm system and monitors their smoke detectors.

“We need to be sure we can be reached by emergency services, and to be able to reach out” in the event of a disaster, the Ellises wrote last month in a public comment to the Federal Commu-

cations Commission. The deadly firestorms that erupted in Los Angeles in 2025, they noted, proved “minutes made the difference between life and death.”

Old copper landlines are going the way of so many other aging pieces of technology as smartphones have become the way many people surf the web, pay bills, watch movies and keep up with friends and family. But some residents of L.A. and California — particularly those who live in fire-prone areas — are determined to hold on to their traditional phones.

As telecommunications giant AT&T accelerates its push to retire landline service to about 184,000 households and 15,000 businesses across the state, hundreds of Californians have voiced alarm in public comments. Many who rely on copper-wire [See **Landlines**, A7]



MALIA BYRTUS California Wolf Project/UC Berkeley

CALIFORNIA had 55 wolves at the end of 2025. Most live in the state’s northeast.

Wolves return to feast on cattle

Study says packs grew from targeting easy, not natural, prey

By CLARA HARTER

The return of the wolf in California has been met with joy by conservationists, who delight in the improbable population rebound, and with fury by ranchers who bemoan the toll on their cattle.

Now, a new study on the diet of gray wolves suggests that the population regrowth is a result of the animals feasting on cattle, as their natural prey sources remain compar-

atively scarce.

Researchers at UC Davis found cattle DNA in 72% of wolf scat samples collected in the summers of 2022 and 2023.

By comparison mule deer, the primary natural prey for wolves in California, appeared in 45% of samples, and small mammals appeared in 51% of samples.

“Whether it’s through scavenging or whether it’s through depredation, [cattle are] a huge component of the wolves’ diet,” said Tina Saitone, lead study author

and professor in the UC Davis agricultural and resource economics department. “Their conservation success is because of livestock producers in the state.”

The study reaffirms fears that many wolves are becoming dependent on cattle as a primary food source as it is easier to feed on slow-moving, fatty cows than stalk the state’s dwindling deer population.

Some irregular food items such as chicken and [See **Wolves**, A7]

LAUSD at risk of insolvency due to union contracts

County gives district 45 days to revise its budget or risk losing control over spending.

By JAWEED KALEEM, HOWARD BLUME AND KORI MCNAIR

The Los Angeles Unified School District faces “severe” indications that it will be insolvent by November 2027 — falling \$231 million into the red and unable to make payroll — county analysts have concluded, setting up a 45-day deadline for the school board to amend its budget or face losing significant future authority over spending decisions.

The county has appointed a fiscal expert to work with the district to eliminate the projected deficit. If that effort falls short, county authorities will appoint an official empowered to overturn school board spending decisions, according to the letter sent to L.A. Unified.

The July 2 notice, from county education office Supt. Debra Duardo to L.A. school board President Scott Schmerelson, said the district’s recent budget adoption “erodes confidence” in its decision-making. The county attributes the crisis largely to union contracts it repeatedly

warned L.A. Unified officials the district could not afford. The projected annual cost of the union settlements and employee raises is well over \$1 billion a year.

“They have some serious financial concerns that they need to address,” Duardo said in an interview Thursday. “It’s very serious.”

The letter formally issues LAUSD a “Lack of Going Concern” determination, meaning the district may not be able to meet its obligations in the 2027-28 and 2028-29 school years. It is a step the Los Angeles County Office of Education takes only when a district faces serious deficit spending, Duardo said.

L.A. schools Supt. Andrés E. Chait suggested there is no need for alarm.

“This determination does not change our commitment to students, families or employees,” Chait said in a statement. “Our schools will continue to operate as normal while we work closely with LACOE to strengthen our long-term financial outlook. We welcome [See **LAUSD**, A8]

Inglewood to gain control of schools

District has improved standards after cuts in jobs and enrollment in the 14 years since a state bailout. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

State sees a surge in venture capital

AI is behind most of the \$335-billion influx in California, far more than elsewhere in U.S.

By NILESH CHRISTOPHER

Despite concerns that California’s costs and regulations are bad for business, the state has attracted an unprecedented pile of capital this year, and no other state is even close.

California’s deep pool of talent, rich investors and other tech infrastructure have made it ground zero for the artificial intelligence explosion. That has helped it attract more than \$335 billion in venture capital funding this year, according to PitchBook’s private market funding data released Thursday.

Its next biggest competitor, New York, raised less than a tenth of California’s total. Texas raised 1/40th of the amount.

“California has far and away the most [deals]. Obviously, a huge amount of that sits in the [San Francisco]

Bay Area,” said Kyle Stanford, director of U.S. venture capital research at PitchBook. “Los Angeles, San Diego has a really strong tech market that I think benefits a lot from capital moving easily between San Francisco and L.A.”

Although a campaign for a new tax on billionaires has convinced some ultra-rich residents to shift to other states, and businesses often complain that high property and energy costs and an anti-business regulatory regime make it too tough to make money in the state, the inability of the top talent, companies and investors in AI to set up elsewhere shows California’s enduring attraction.

The state’s economy grew 5% last year to a record \$4.25 trillion, making it larger than every country other than the U.S., China and Germany. It is home to nearly 400 billion-dollar startups — more than any other state, according to CB Insights.

Southern California has emerged as a go-to address for fast-growing space and [See **Funding**, A12]

Police academy may pause for LA28

LAPD officials are debating whether to reassign teachers, others to patrol the Games. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Hotels saved by surge in Cup fans

After May’s slow start, hoteliers say they’re at capacity with tourists and charging higher rates. **BUSINESS, A10**

Fire crews get OK to use masks

Waiting for the perfect breathing gear has left firefighters exposed to dangerous smoke, experts say. **CLIMATE, A9**

Weather
Mostly sunny.
L.A. Basin: 84/64. **B6**

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ROBERT F. BUKATY AP
PLATNER ended his run amid assault claims.

Democrats plan summit in Maine

The party scrambles to replace Graham Platner after he exits the U.S. Senate race. **NATION, A5**

Markets **A12**
Opinion Voices **A13**

July 4 was too much for Newport Beach

Holiday weekend was the tipping point for some who want city to revisit limiting access.

By HANNAH FRY

The Balboa Peninsula has a long and sometimes infamous history as a party beach.

A generation ago, drunk-

en summers of house parties and spontaneous gatherings earned it the nicknames “Zooport” and “the war zone.”

It was here where NBA star Dennis Rodman threw weekend-long blowouts in the early 2000s, once making his grand entrance for a birthday bash by landing on the beach in a helicopter.

But last weekend’s mayhem, in which thousands descended on the community

and more than 400 ended up under arrest, has hit Newport Beach differently, spurring calls for city leaders to take decisive action. Some residents want the city to consider actions from an earlier era, including limiting how many people can be in the beach zone at one time.

Beach cities have always had a complex relationship with summer crowds.

Newport Beach relies on

\$1.2 billion in spending from roughly 4 million tourists annually and has worked for more than a decade to revitalize the peninsula, in part to attract visitors. For visitors from inland areas, a trip to the beach offers a relief valve from triple-digit temperatures and is a relatively inexpensive family excursion.

The beaches are supposed to be open to every- [See **Newport**, A8]